

7.5.3 WinGuard Pro 2006

This is another program that's mildly crippled, but it does let you get things done. The interface is uncluttered, help is helpful, and the program is easy to use on the whole. Just remember never to forget your password(s)!

The program, as expected, sits in the system tray, with the main functions a click away. As you can see in the screenshots, there are several operations you can do to



WinGuard Pro allows you to 'lock' certain regions of your computer

restrict access to certain areas of your computer. You can lock the workstation altogether, but this feature is useless—pressing [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [Del] allowed us to end task!

Apart from that, you can encrypt the contents of any folder (although encrypting subfolders with one click is not possible in the free edition; you need to manually encrypt each subfolder). Also, you can, for example, choose to restrict access to the Control Panel. When you've done this, and then try to open the Control Panel, a message comes up saying that the Control Panel has been locked, and that it is not accessible—you need to unlock it using the password you provided.

Overall, the idea of this program is to restrict access to *regions* of your computer—whether it's a folder, a saved Web page, the Control Panel, the Registry Editor, or whatever—pretty useful. And though it sits in the system tray, exiting the program isn't the solution for would-be snoopers—you need to supply the password upon exit, of course!



All of WinGuard's configuration can be done in a matter of minutes